

ENGAGE – Battery-free Gameboy

Scientists at Northwestern University have come up with a Gameboy that can run forever without a battery. Josiah Hester, co-leader of the project, explained that this is the first battery-free interactive device that harvests energy from user actions. On pressing a button, the device converts that energy into something that can power the device.

Dubbed the ENGAGE, it features the same size and form-factor as a



traditional Gameboy. However, this version has two solar panels attached on the front. But that's not all, like Hester explained above, there's a second source of energy. Button presses. The device converts the kinetic energy from that into usable energy for the device. Additionally, the buttons are wired to a set of capacitors that allow the machine to remain powered up, no matter how long it's been set aside.

Samsung transparent smartphone

Samsung is apparently working on developing a transparent smartphone. The company has patented a design recently which surfaced at WIPO. The patent was published as recently as August 27 and was filed back in January. It explains the tech that would go into such a device.



The same tech would also apply to other devices with displays, such as TVs, monitors and laptops. In fact, the Mi TV LUX is a transparent TV that we showcased recently in this section.

While the tech is similar, wherein transparent luminous display panels would be used, there are certain problems and limitations that arise when using this technology with smartphones, such as making a majority of internal components transparent. Time will tell how it will turn out.

Nintendo Game & Watch

To celebrate the 35th anniversary of the iconic Super Mario Bros franchise, Nintendo have released the original Game & Watch handheld, revamped with a full-colour LCD. The device was showcased at their recent Nintendo Direct event.

In addition to Super Mario Bros, the handheld can also play Super Mario

Bros: The Lost Levels (aka Super Mario Bros. 2 in Japan) and an updated version of Game & Watch: Ball, which stars Mario this time, instead of Mr. Game & Watch. The Game & Watch also functions as a digital clock, hence the name. It also has 35 easter-eggs, for the 35th anniversary. The device is set to release on November 13.



LG battery-powered face mask

LG has come up with a battery-powered air purifying face mask which comes with two high-quality HEPA filters, which can remove at least 99.97% of particulates from the air, down to 0.3 microns in size. Considering the current situation with the novel coronavirus pandemic, it does seem like the mask will get some



attention, and LG plans to reveal the mask at the IFA trade show in Berlin. Official pricing and release date for the mask hasn't been revealed as of writing this. However, technical specifications include a 820mAh battery powering dual fans and filters. The battery will reportedly last about 2 hours on the highest setting, and 8 hours on the lowest. The mask case will be able to charge the battery, and also disinfects the mask with UV light.